# Post-Matric Scholarship

Eligibility, benefits, documents and application guidance for post-secondary students in Maharashtra

## 1. Meaning of post-matric scholarship

Post-matric schemes support eligible students studying after Class 10 (SSC or equivalent). MahaDBT lists several post-matric schemes administered by different departments. This guide explains the prominent Social Justice scheme for Scheduled Caste / Neo-Buddhist students and highlights that other categories have separate rules.

There is no single income limit or benefit amount for every post-matric scholarship. Always open the exact scheme page for your category.

## 2. Government of India Post-Matric Scholarship (SC / Neo-Buddhist)

- Category: the official Social Justice and Special Assistance Department scheme is for Scheduled Caste or Neo-Buddhist students.
- Residence and study: the student should be a Maharashtra resident and studying above Class 10.
- Family income: parents'/guardian's annual income should be up to ■2.50 lakh for the full scholarship, as stated on the Maharashtra Government scheme page.
- Benefits may include maintenance allowance, tuition fees, examination fees and other approved fees, subject to the scheme rules.
- Maintenance allowance varies by course group and whether the student is a hosteller or day scholar. The Government page lists day-scholar rates from ■250 to ■700 per month and hosteller rates from ■400 to ■1,350 per month for the relevant categories/course groups.

## 3. Post-Matric Tuition Fee and Examination Fee (Freeship)

- This is a separate Social Justice scheme, not the same as the income-limited Post-Matric Scholarship.
- Eligibility shown on the MahaDBT scheme page: Scheduled Caste or Neo-Buddhist student; Maharashtra resident; passed SSC/equivalent; family income above ■2.50 lakh (no upper limit stated on that scheme page); recognized institute in Maharashtra.
- For professional courses, admission through CAP is required as stated on the scheme page.
- The scheme page states that only one failure is allowed in the whole curriculum.
- Benefit: reimbursement of tuition fees, examination fees and other compulsory/admissible fees, subject to scheme approval and applicable rules.

## 4. Common documents

- Income certificate issued by the competent authority (where required by the selected scheme).
- Caste certificate and caste validity certificate.
- Marksheets of the last appeared examination and SSC/HSC, as applicable.
- Current admission/bonafide certificate and fee receipt.
- CAP allotment letter for professional courses where CAP admission is required.
- Hostel certificate if claiming hosteller-related benefits; any additional document requested by the portal/institute.

## 5. Application and renewal checklist

- Register/login to MahaDBT and complete all profile fields accurately.
- Choose the exact post-matric scheme applicable to your category and income; compare Scholarship vs Freeship conditions.

- Upload readable documents with matching names, dates and details. Resolve discrepancies before final submission.
- Submit before the portal's academic-year deadline and save the application ID/acknowledgement.
- Track scrutiny and respond promptly if the institute returns the application for correction.
- For renewal, check academic progression, result/marksheet and renewal conditions for the current year.

## 6. Important distinction

For SC/Neo-Buddhist students, the ■2.50 lakh income threshold separates the two Social Justice schemes described above: the Government of India Post-Matric Scholarship (up to ■2.50 lakh) and the Post-Matric Freeship (above ■2.50 lakh). This distinction should not be generalized to OBC, VJNT, SBC, ST, minority or open-category schemes.

## Official references

**Government of Maharashtra — Government of India Post-Matric Scholarship**
https://sjsa.maharashtra.gov.in/en/scheme/government-of-india-post-matric-scholarship-scheme/

**MahaDBT — Post-Matric Freeship scheme page**
https://mahadbt.maharashtra.gov.in/SchemeData/SchemeData?str=E9DDFA703C38E51AE0CB048159E784170A4F3BD768B3A64E4772B0EF7B9990B2

**MahaDBT portal**
https://mahadbt.maharashtra.gov.in/

Important note: This PDF is an explanatory guide compiled from official Maharashtra Government / MahaDBT pages available at the time of preparation (7 November 2026). Scheme conditions, benefit amounts, required documents, application windows and Government Resolutions can change. The live scheme page and latest GR prevail if anything differs.